In 2009, there were a little over a 1,00,000 refugees in Tamil Nadu, and 70 per cent were living in 115 government-run camps across twenty-six districts. The camps have strict surveillance, few government benefits, temporary houses and rationed provisions. Movements out of the camps are closely watched, restricting the scope for meaningful employment. There is, therefore, a desire to escape camp life and India, to greener and freer pastures abroad. This is sometimes facilitated by strong social networks that have been cultivated by the global Sri Lankan diaspora. Another way out is by marrying locals and attaining Indian citizenship that provides a range of benefits. But until the camps are finally shut down, the Sri Lankan refugee issue will continue to be India's biggest refugee problem, as it has been for the past three decades.

Kashmir

Kalhana's 12th century CE Sanskrit classic on Kashmir, *Rajatarangini,* marks one of the first systematic efforts at history-writing in India. At one point, it alludes to trading interactions between Kashmiri kings and mlecchas or foreigners, interpreted by historians as a reference to Muslims.[62] Some eight centuries later, after invasions, conversions and assimilation, Muslims formed over 90 per cent of the population of the Kashmir valley and in a role reversal, Kalhana's community, most likely Kashmiri Hindus, were perceived by some as *mlecchas* of the Kashmir valley.

The exodus of over 2,00,000 Kashmiris in 1989–90 due to intimidation and violence within their own country defies belief.[63] The fearsome atmosphere that led to the exodus is best recounted by Jagmohan, who was then the governor of Jammu and Kashmir:[64]

> The ruthless Kalashnikov, the 350 bomb explosions in the second half of 1989, the hysterical exhortations of 'Jihad' from hundreds of loudspeakers fitted on mosques, the 'Tirana-e-Kashmir' of having the Quran in one hand and a rifle in the other, the sinister design of 'killing one and frightening one thousand' . . . impelled the Kashmiris to abandon their homes and hearths in the Valley and move to the inhospitable camps of Jammu.